Marvyn-Stephano Zalewski

Engineering Manager - Cloud Platform

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Summary

People-centric Engineering Manager with over **10 years** of experience building and scaling various **Cloud Platforms**. Proven outcome in leading **datacentre-to-AWS migrations**, driving **FinOps** excellence with **$1M+** in annual savings, and modernizing **DevOps** cultures through **Team Topologies** and **operating model design**. I bridge the gap between complex infrastructure and business outcomes, focusing on **simplification**, **observability**, and measurable **Developer Experience (DX)** improvements.

German citizen and eligible to work across the EU.

Skills

Technologies: AWS, AWS MAP, AWS Backup, Terraform, Docker, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, GitHub Enterprise, Jira Service Management, Observability (logs/metrics/traces), FinOps, Datadog, Cloudformation, Ansible

Security: SPLC, AWS Security Hub, Guardrails (SCPs), IAM Identity Center, Guardduty, RBAC, Risk Management, NIST, Incident Response, Application Security Assessments, highly regulated environments (PCI-DSS, ISO27001)

Programming: Python, Java, TypeScript, Javascript, Bash

Frameworks: Angular, React, NestJS, Next.js

Leadership: Team Topologies, You Build It You Run It, SRE, ADRs, Psychological Safety, OKRs, Scrumban, Coaching/Mentoring, Change Management, Cross-cultural and remote Teams, Stakeholder Management, Communication, System Thinking, Storytelling, agility

Experience

Engineering Manager - Cloud Platform, Awin Global – Barcelona, Spain Aug 2024 – present

Leading cross-cultural Cloud Platform and DevOps teams: owning the cloud platform strategy, the datacentre-to-AWS migration, the DevOps transformation, and FinOps.

- Leading the **datacentre-to-AWS migration (Project Evolve)**: ran vendor selection and contracting, secured **100% AWS MAP funding** for phase one (**$150k+** saved), and drove the migration of **1,400+ VMs** towards datacentre exit in 2027.
- Hired and onboarded **8 engineers** since September 2025 across multiple European countries and seniority levels (junior to senior), rebuilding the Cloud Platform and DevOps teams after a re-org.
- Made **GitHub Actions** the company-wide CI/CD standard (~50 contributors), with golden pipelines that cut new-service setup by **~16 hours**, **OIDC** short-lived credentials, and governance across **900+ repos**.
- Wrote and rolled out a **You Build It, You Run It** operating model and **SRE strategy**, re-implemented **incident management** and closed internal audit actions; the Enablement DevOps pilot is now scaling to all domains, and AWS rated the model as mature.
- Established and led **FinOps**: **$84k+ monthly savings** across **AWS** and **Datadog** on **$3.5M+/year** spend, and cut budget-vs-actual variance from **20% to 3%** through domain-level forecasting.
- In the company-wide **DX survey**, raised the **DevOps engagement score** (all engineering teams rating DevOps/CPE) from **68 -> 82** and my team's rating of me as manager and of P&T from **62 -> 73** Focus Time, Supporter of the Week and a psychological-safety assessment also lifted **Peakon** engagement from **7.2 -> 8.3**.

Cloud DevOps Manager, Awin Global – Barcelona, Spain Jan 2024 – July 2024

Restructured team and operating model to remove bottlenecks and clarify ownership using Team Topologies.

- Analyzed bottlenecks, defined a new **department charter**, and executed a re-organization into **DevOps**, **Cloud Platform**, and **IT Ops** in collaboration with the Engineering department.
- Managed **3 senior DevOps engineers** across Germany and Italy to conclude the **AWS landing zone** and related infrastructure for further organizational adoption.
- Replaced Docker Desktop with open source tools and achieved **$18,000 annual savings**.
- Hired two managers to lead the newly formed sister teams.

Security Architect, AVIV Group – Hamburg, Germany July 2022 – Jan 2024

Built and scaled a self-service Secure Product Lifecycle (SPLC) for AVIV's cloud-native products.

- Launched the **SPLC** and matured it into a self-service program (dynamic questionnaire and standardized risk reports) that improved application delivery times without additional headcount.
- Concluded **50+** application security assessments in 9 months and uncovered **80+ unique risks**.
- Reduced recurring findings by prioritizing platform-level fixes with implemented controls from preventative **SCPs** to automated responses and notifications.
- Raised security awareness across Product & Tech through an ongoing culture program (presentations, architecture guidelines, newsletter) embedded in team rituals.
- Established KPIs (**cycle time**, **completion rates**, **developer satisfaction**) and used them to drive iterative improvements and leadership reporting.

Security Officer Germany, AVIV Group – Hamburg, Germany Feb 2022 – Jan 2023

Delivered merger integration and AWS security foundations that improved control coverage and audit readiness.

- Ran the security integration stream for the German businesses, aligned controls to **CIS** and group standards, and facilitated internal audits.
- Developed and implemented the security stream for the **AWS landing zone** covering **IAM Identity Center**, a **Transit Gateway** hub-and-spoke network architecture, and centralized security logging and monitoring.
- Further fortified the **AWS** security posture via **SCPs**, **Prowler**, and **AWS Security Hub**.

Cyber Security Specialist, immowelt GmbH – Hamburg, Germany Oct 2021 – June 2022

Established the company's first cybersecurity function and embedded security and privacy by design into the SDLC.

- Improved cloud security posture via custom automation and **Prowler** scanning across **100+ AWS accounts**.
- Implemented and applied a **NIST**-based maturity model for the product teams and updated the **RCA** process to align with the product development lifecycle.
- Championed security culture with a company-wide **Capture-The-Flag (CTF)** program.

DevOps Engineer, immowelt GmbH – Hamburg, Germany Aug 2015 – Sept 2021

Pioneered a modern DevOps culture and rebuilt the main product with an AWS-native architecture.

- Modernized the legacy config management monolith by replacing **Puppet** with modular **Ansible** and introducing a temporary **Docker** platform based on **DC/OS Mesosphere** to increase stability and enable loosely coupled microservices.
- Managed, updated, and automated 3 Datacenters with over 50 Linux and Windows based physical servers based on KVM, Opennebula, and Hyper-V.
- Championed a **DevOps** culture and "You build it, you run it" model for an all-in **AWS** rebuild of the private property search, enabling autonomous delivery.
- Engineered **GitLab CI/CD** with **Terraform** (later **CDKTF**), including environment standards and **ephemeral stacks** to accelerate testing and releases.
- Developed multiple products in **Java**, **Python**, **TypeScript**, and frontends (**Angular**, **React**) to deliver customer value.
- Shipped the **AWS-native MVP** of the **Search Engine Result Page (SERP)**, immowelt's main product for property search, in **8 months** and completed the full feature set **9 months** later.

IT-Support, Goodgame Studios – Hamburg, Germany Feb 2014 – July 2015

Provided IT support in a fast-growing gaming company while managing Windows Server infrastructure.

- Provided 2nd and 3rd level IT support for **800+ internal users** across two locations.
- Automated routine tasks using **PowerShell** and **AutoIT** scripts to improve efficiency.

Projects

- https://play40.app — **Play40**, an online version of Ecuador's national card game, built solo on serverless **AWS** (AppSync, Lambda, DynamoDB, Terraform) with a **Next.js** frontend.

Education

tectumHOME GmbH, Apprenticeship IT Systems Electronics Technician – Hamburg, Germany Sept 2011 – Jan 2014

State Trade School G18, Hamburg, Higher Education Entrance Qualification – Hamburg, Germany Apr 2014

Languages

- **German** (native) · **English** (fluent) · **Spanish** (working proficiency)

Interests

- **Cycling**, **Muay Thai**, **specialty coffee** (trained others in brewing), and **learning languages**.